Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report
Residential Care

Licensee: Family Solutions – Cascade House
Executive Director: Dorothy Provencio
Program Manager: Susan Shorey
Board Chairperson: Roy Lindsay

Date of Unannounced: March 13, 2024
Licensing Coordinator: Robin DuVal

Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: Oregon Health Authority (OHA) and Oregon Department of Human Services Child Welfare Treatment **Services (ODHS).**

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings **Unannounced Site Visit 08/23/2023**	**Repeat Findings Further Action Needed**	**Comments**
Medication 419-470-0100(9) Written record of the disposal of medications is maintained and includes: (a) description and amount (b) name (c) reason (d) method (e) staff & witness signature (9)(e) The agency shall ensure staff and witness provide a signature, not initials. *Note: This licensor and staff discussed ways to update documentation and processes. The agency is working on updating policies and procedures to be clearer and reduce potential errors.* Requirement (9)(e) remains unmet: initials instead of signatures; and several instances with only one staff person without a witness.	**Yes☐ No☐ N/A✓**	The last documented disposal was from August 2023, therefore nothing new to review. This area will be reviewed at a future visit. *The agencies corrective action response from the 8/23/2023 visit is on record.*

Some disposed medications are disposed on-site utilizing the Rx Destroyer product, however other disposed medications were in a bin labeled "disposal" with no tracking document within said bin, creating a risk of mismanagement or theft. When speaking to several staff and the program manager, there was a lack of clarity on the process of medication administration documentation and medication disposal and disposal documentation. There have been recent staff changes, and new hires that may not have received required training. **Corrective Action.** The Agency shall: 1) Ensure staff and a witness provide a signature, not initials. 2) Ensure two staff (one staff and one staff witness) are disposing medications and signing the disposal record. 3) Review medication policies and procedures to ensure it meets requirements in related OARs and the practices set forth by Family Solutions. 4) Ensure all staff who handle medications are provided medication policies and procedures, are trained, and demonstrate competency before administering and disposing medications as well as proper documentation. 5) Ensure management oversight for quality check and assurances and any follow-up training needed. ****This is a repeat finding.****		
Medication 419-470-0100(10) Written record of the administration of medication includes: (a) name (b) description (c) dates and times **(d) missed doses** **(e) medication disposed** (f) method of administration (g) ID of person administering (h) possible adverse reactions (i) medication taken outside facility Requirements (10)(d) and (e) are unmet. The agency shall ensure all requirements are included on the medication administration record. *Note: This licensor and staff discussed ways to update documentation and processes. The agency is working on updating policies and procedures to be clearer and reduce potential errors.*	**Yes✓ No☐**	(d) There were several blank areas on the medication administration record with no corresponding notes to document the circumstances where space is provided for such notes on the back of the sheet. ****This is a repeat finding.**** (e) There was no noted medication disposed, therefore nothing new to review. This area will be reviewed at a future visit. *The agencies corrective action response from the 8/23/2023 visit is on record.*

There were several blank areas on the medication administration record with no corresponding notes to document the circumstances where space is provided for such notes on the back of the sheet. When speaking to several staff and the program manager, there was a lack of clarity on the process of medication administration documentation and medication disposal and disposal documentation. There have been recent staff changes, and new hires that may not have received required training. **Corrective Action** – The Agency shall: 1) The agency shall ensure the written record of the medication administration are filled out accurately with no blanks, indicating missed doses or medication disposed. • Medication errors, or anomalies in documentation or administration, can be documented by adding a notation to the medication administration record. 2) Review medication policies and procedures to ensure it meets requirements in related OARs and the practices set forth by Family Solutions. 3) Ensure all staff who handle medications are provided medication policies and procedures, are trained, and demonstrate competency before administering and disposing medications as well as proper documentation. 4) Ensure management oversight for quality check and assurances and any follow-up training needed. ****This is a repeat finding.****		
Physical Plant Requirements 419-470-0020(2)(c) All areas of buildings where children in care are present must be kept clean and in good repair. Major appliances and heating, ventilation, plumbing, and electrical systems must be functional and in good repair. All upstairs toilets had various levels of rings in the toilet indicating a deep cleaning and regular upkeep was lacking. It's recommended that the agency utilize Collaborative Problem Solving techniques to encourage the youth to meet cleaning expectations. • **Corrective Action #1**: The agency is ultimately responsible and must ensure agency staff are completing necessary cleaning. There is dark discolored flooring around one of the upstairs toilets indicating a potential water leak, mold, rotting floor, or other unknown reason. Mold is a health hazard, and a rotting floor structure is a safety concern. • **Corrective Action #2**: The agency shall seek out a professional assessment and remedy the problem.	**Yes☐ No✓**	Correction #1: The toilet bowls were observed to be averagely clean. *The agency noted in their Corrective Action response from 8/23/2023 that per the Medford Water Commission, the Medford water chemical make-up tends to react with materials in some toilets creating ongoing staining that is difficult to remove.* Correction #2: It was discovered the toilet ring was causing leaking and needed to be replaced. The under flooring was treated and the toilet ring and flooring were replaced on 9/7/2023. This bathroom was observed and has been corrected. There is no further corrective action needed at this time.

New Findings from Site Visit	Corrective Actions
419-470-0100(3) A prescription, signed by a physician or qualified medical professional, is required before any prescription medication is administered to a child in care.	Staff discovered a pharmacy error (AM vs. PM) on the label of a refill medication, they called the physician to confirm the exact time for administration and handwrote the change on the Medication Administration Record (MAR), however there was no documented evidence to verify. • **Corrective Action:** The agency shall ensure such documentation is retained.
419-470-0100(10) Medication records.	Sticky notes were on several youth's MARs, indicating various notes or instructions with no corresponding notes to document the circumstances where space is provided for such notes on the back of the sheet. • **Corrective Action:** The agency shall ensure any errors, or anomalies in documentation or administration, are documented by adding a notation to the medication administration record. *Note: use of sticky notes is allowed as long as the information is documented on the MAR as well.*
419-470-0030(4)(a)(G) Bathrooms: A window covering on each window to ensure privacy.	There was no window covering in one of the upstairs bathrooms. The window size is large, and placement is lower to the floor which is directly next to the toilet and faces a main street outside. When this licensor brought this concern forward, the agency gathered information and discovered the window covering had fallen down the night prior. The agency remedied this later that day and sent a picture to confirm. • **Corrective Action:** The agency shall ensure a bathroom window covering is always in place.
419-470-0030(3)(i) Bedrooms: A window covering to ensure privacy.	One youth's bedroom was missing a window covering. This youth was out of the program at the time. • **Corrective Action:** The agency shall ensure this window covering is in place prior to the youth returning, as well as ensuring all bedroom window coverings are always in place.
Physical Plant Requirements 419-470-0020(2)(c) All areas of buildings where children in care are present must be kept clean and in good repair. Major appliances and heating, ventilation, plumbing, and electrical systems must be functional and in good repair.	Toilet seats had various levels of uncleanliness. The agency is ultimately responsible to ensure agency staff are completing necessary and routine cleaning. • **Corrective Action:** The agency shall ensure oversight to ensure cleanliness.

Interview Summary
Two youth were individually interviewed, both ages 15, and they have been in the program approximately 6 months and 8 months, respectively. Both youth reported that they are not gaining anything or benefiting from the program services. Although they noted the program efforts, they said the efforts don't match their needs. They report feeling safe here, peers are tolerable, some staff are trusting and there's no issues getting their medications as prescribed. The food is good, consisting of prepared meals for dinner and occasionally heated up frozen food. Rules and expectations are always changing, and communication is poor and inconsistent, making it hard to know what the rules and expectations are day-to-day, staff-to-staff, and shift-to-shift. They reported frustrations with staff inconsistences regarding youth losing privileges and when to expect to gain them back. Both youth report that the program therapist was not a good fit, and they both see an outside therapist. Outings are mainly on Saturdays: going to the park, shopping, or on a drive, and going to the YMCA during the week for swimming or working out. School is boring, but they get help. Youth report wanting to do more activities, both in and out of the program. Their daily routine consists of room time, classroom, meals, living room for tv or gaming, which is a lot of sitting around and no regular physical activity or fresh air. They reported a recent rule change where youth can no longer "take space" on the porch outside. Outside walks rarely happen due to staffing and staff ratios, and if youth are split

about going on a walk or not, it just doesn't happen. They report that it feels "suffocating". Groups haven't happened in a long time; they guessed since January. They report having regular phone calls with approved persons; however, they haven't been getting privacy for these calls. The kitchen phone (where most private calls are conducted) was removed for reasons they don't know, and the cordless phone doesn't always work downstairs. They reported the agency does well at "check-ins" with the youth. If they could change anything about the program, it would be better communication, less changing of rules, and more consistency among staff. It's not often they see the program manager. One youth submitted a grievance about the program manager to the Executive Director, but they didn't receive a response so they just "dropped it." There is one staff person who is part-time and is one of the main staff for outings, who can be disrespectful, which makes the outing days less enjoyable.

Agency follow-up from youth interviews

1) Assess the situation regarding youth privacy for phone calls and make any adjustments to ensure privacy is occurring. Provide a written response to this licensor.
2) Provide documentation of the grievance noted above to this licensor and the agency response.

Observations

The facility is an aging building that was originally built as a house. It has original or aging bathrooms and some areas appear more worn down. One upstairs bathroom is out of order, the upstairs "quad" room is not in use, and both are locked and not accessible to youth. There are two other bathrooms, and this is sufficient for their current census. The agency works at keeping the facility maintained and clean. One upstairs bathroom floor was replaced, as noted above. One bathroom was missing a window covering, as noted above. Youth bedrooms were observed, and there were various levels of tidiness, and one bedroom window missing a window covering, as noted above. Food was observed in the kitchen cupboards and in refrigerators and freezers. The walk-through consisted of bedrooms, bathrooms, kitchen, dining room, living room, and the staff and medication office. Youth had just recently ended their on-site school day and were either in their bedrooms or hanging out in the hallway with two staff. One youth was on a call to their sibling, on speaker, while sitting in the hallway with staff.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes: Please submit the following to verify compliance.

Within 45 days of receipt of this report **Family Solutions** must submit a letter of verification indicating the agency is in compliance with the specific rules cited above and describing how compliance will be maintained going forward. Along with the letter of verification, the agency must submit any and all specific documentation requested in the body of this report. The letter of verification and any additional requested documents are to be emailed directly to Robin DuVal at robin.m.duval@odhsoha.oregon.gov.

Licensing Coordinator's Signature: Robin DuVal Date: 3/25/2024

Manager Review: _____ Date: 3-25-2024